



Dutch leave Indonesia
As Indonesia gains independence in 1949, servants carry 300 portraits of former Dutch governors out of the colonial residence, marking the end of over 340 years of imperial rule.

and Soviet Union all refused to support the imperialist invasion. Humiliated, Britain and France withdrew. The crisis ended in a victory for

1948, which led to armed confrontation. British troops defeated the Chinese guerrillas in 1952 and withdrew from Malaya in 1957 once the Federation of Malaya had been established.

The Suez crisis

The most significant crisis of British and French withdrawal from empire came in 1956 when President Nasser (see left) nationalized the Suez Canal. The canal, which links the Mediterranean and Red Sea through Egyptian territory, had been under British and French control since its construction in 1869. It represented a key route for the transport of raw materials to Europe. Anglo-French forces attacked Egypt to wrest the canal back from Egyptian control, but the United Nations, US,

Arab nationalism and signaled the decline of the old powers of Europe.

African conflicts

France's determination to maintain control of Algeria in northern Africa led to guerrilla fighting between the Algerian *Front de Libération Nationale* (FLN) and French security forces from 1954. By 1960, the violence had escalated and the independence issue was bitterly dividing the French nation. French army generals in Algeria then attempted a coup d'état. Independence was agreed in 1962. The struggle left deep scars on both French and Algerian national consciousness.

The dismantling of colonies in Africa spawned many territorial wars between African Nations. This was due in part to

the fact that European governments had divided the continent along arbitrary borders that paid no attention to tribal boundaries (see pp.360–61).

150,000 The estimated death toll in the French–Algerian conflict.

As imperial powers withdrew, many nations also descended into civil war.

When the Belgian government abruptly granted independence to the Congo in 1960, violence erupted as different Congolese factions struggled to gain control of the nation's remarkable natural wealth. The Congo's nominally democratic government, installed at independence, failed in 1965 when Lieutenant General Mobutu seized power in a military coup.

After independence

Through the 1960s and 70s, transitions to independence became generally peaceful and independence was established across most of the world. However, independent government in the Third World has not equalized the distribution of global wealth and power. While former colonies such as Hong Kong and Singapore (see pp.456–57) have flourished post-empire, many others are among the world's poorest nations.

Paris riots

Growing opposition in France to French suppression of the Nationalist Movement in Algeria exploded into riots on the streets of Paris as French protesters clashed with the French Army and the notorious CRS riot squad in 1961. A ceasefire was called in Algeria in 1962. Later that year the Algerian people voted for independence.

AFTER

In many cases, democracies established post-empire failed to survive, and military or one-party rule was established.

MILITARY REGIMES

In some countries power was seized in military coups, such as that led by Idi Amin in Uganda in 1971. **Ethnic violence and political repression** were rife under the military regimes.

DEMOCRACY

With a few exceptions, such as the independent Republic of Ghana, democracies established post-empire have failed in much of Africa. Elected national parliaments have often been **unable to establish unity** in countries, such as Sudan, that are divided along tribal lines.



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